

Severe crunch for Harvard school

Bracing for a long-term loss of health funding

By Kay Lazar and Jonathan Saltzman
GLOBE STAFF

Harvard's T.H. Chan School of Public Health is bracing for the possibility of losing as much as half of its federal research funding in the coming years, some \$100 million annually, prompting the school to take extraordinary measures, such as asking corporations to underwrite the tuition of PhD candidates.

The school has already laid off an undisclosed number of staffers, reduced its class of PhD students by nearly half, and shelved research projects because of a harsh new reality: the government is shifting away from funding public health.

"We are cutting spending across the school and focusing our resources on our highest priority research," Andrea Baccarelli, the Chan School's dean of faculty and a renowned environmental health researcher, said in a statement. "That has been a painful process, as we have had to lay off highly valued colleagues and shut down important science, but it is the response."

HARVARD, Page A16

Questions, hope for autism treatment

By Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

When Angelo Casanova returned home to Waterbury, Conn., earlier this month after an overseas deployment for the US Army, he was greeted by an unexpected development that brought tears to his eyes: His 4-year-old autistic sister, Willnelys, who previously had been non-verbal, pointed to herself and said her name for the first time.

The change started in July when their mother, Esther Mena, found a doctor in New York to prescribe leucovorin — a medication for cancer patients that had been generating buzz within the autism community for its purported ability to help kids speak.

Within just a week, Mena noticed improvements in her daughter's behavior: reciting numbers, identifying colors out loud and making animal noises after visiting a farm. Now two months later, Willnelys is more alert, more engaged, and has developed a fondness for food she

AUTISM, Page A16

Trump's hand on the budget ax

An architect of Project 2025, Russ Vought emerges as White House force on spending, presidential reach

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The early days of the second Trump administration were largely defined in the public eye by the aggressive, at times chaotic, and heavily publicized cost-cutting actions of the Department

of Government Efficiency and its famous leader, Elon Musk.

Those days and accompanying tumult have faded, and the tech billionaire left the government in May. But efforts to dramatically reshape the government have continued with an arguably more influential figure: Russ Vought, the director of the Office of Management and Budget. And he's just getting started.

"It was always presumed by a lot of the conservative movement that while Elon Musk and DOGE were getting a lot of the attention, Russ was the more effective instrument to cut the size and scope of government," said Erick Erickson, a conservative talk show host who has known Vought for decades.

"There has never been someone at OMB who is as familiar with the interoperation of the federal budget as Russ," continued Erickson, saying Vought would go through the federal budget on his own time as a young, up-and-coming congressional staffer. "It literally was bedtime reading for him. He knows where the appropriations are, he knows how to roll back the appropriations, he knows how to stop them."

Amid a government funding standoff in Congress, Vought flexed that muscle by issuing a memo Wednesday telling federal agencies to prepare for mass layoffs in the event of a shutdown.

VOUGHT, Page A12



PHOTOS BY JESSICA RINALDI/GLOBE STAFF

At top: Visitors to the Boston Public Library's McKim Building took in John Singer Sargent's mural cycle. At right, a statue sat draped in plastic.



Pieces from the Joan of Arc collection are being stored in a section of the library that has been closed to the public for more than a decade.



LIBRARY OF TREASURES, OFF LIMITS

A costly overhaul for BPL rooms with a Narnia-worthy collection

By Malcolm Gay
GLOBE STAFF

The resplendence of the Boston Public Library's McKim Building unfolds with each step up the grand staircase.

Past the imposing stone lions, the golden-hued stairwell gives way to an airy gallery of murals, a millennium-spanning celebration of the muses. Nearby, a narrower stairway leads to the hushed third floor, where people wander the opulent gallery to untangle John Singer Sargent's "Triumph of Religion," a monumental cycle of murals the artist left unfinished despite nearly three decades of work.

Inevitably, some will try the leather-clad door at the end of the gallery, which seems to promise yet more wonders beyond.

But the door is locked.

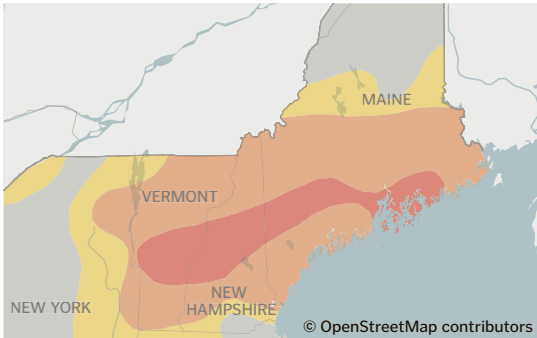
It has been closed to the public for more than a decade, concealing a once-grand enfilade of vaulted ceilings, interior arcades, and elevated walkways that wrap

BPL, Page A20

At farms up north, a withering end to crop season

Parts of Northern New England experiencing extreme drought

Abnormally dry Moderate drought
Severe drought Extreme drought



SOURCE: US Drought Monitor, data as of Sept. 25.
CHRISTINA PRIGNANO/GLOBE STAFF

By Paul Heintz
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

SHOREHAM, Vt. — Bill Suhr and his teenage son spent the past two years digging a vast open pit larger than a football field to hold water for irrigating the family's apple orchards. At 7 million gallons, it should have held him for the season, but after three extremely dry months, it is nearly empty.

"We might as well close the doors if this hadn't been built," Suhr said recently over the whir of a nearby pump as he surveyed the pond's dry banks. For

a time, his kids and a farmhand had marked the water level by jamming sticks in the parched soil every foot it dropped, but eventually they gave up.

"It's a scary year," Suhr said.

Like farmers throughout Northern New England, Suhr has been reckoning with whip-saw weather since the start of the growing season. In May, more than 10 inches of rain inundated his hillside orchards overlooking Lake Champlain. In each month since, only about 1.5 inches fell.

A box of Cortland apples in

DROUGHT, Page A18

Time to exhale, Red Sox Nation, writes Dan Shaughnessy: the Sox are going to the playoffs again. **Sports, C1.**

The Lake Estate on Winnisquam has been flawlessly executed, despite apparent obstacles for the \$90 million resort, says travel writer Christopher Muther. **Travel, N11.**

A young woman was found dead in Ran Duan's house, and the online culture that fueled his rise turned against him. **Globe Magazine.**

Ideological enforcers on the right and the left ought to know by now that it's pointless to tell Americans what they shouldn't laugh at. **Ideas, K1.**

Getting closer

Sunday: Humid. High: 81-86. Low: 59-64.

Monday: Sunny. High: 75-80. Low: 61-66.

High tide: 4:10 a.m. 4:17 p.m.

Sunrise: 6:38 Sunset: 6:31

Complete report, **B10.** Deaths, **A21-25.**

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